RESEARCH STRATEGY

A. SIGNIFICANCE

A.1 ***[Problem statement subsection title]***

[Describe the target condition, population, or scientific problem. Establish prevalence/burden with citations. Describe the clinical or scientific importance. Explain what is currently not understood or not possible. 3–5 sentences.][1]

A.2 ***[Knowledge gap subsection title]***

[Describe the key barrier to progress. This may be a data gap, methodological limitation, or lack of an appropriate tool or resource. Be specific about what is missing and why existing approaches fall short. 3–4 sentences.][1]

A.3 ***[Enabling opportunity subsection title]***

[Describe the specific resource, technology, or data source that now makes this work possible. Explain why this opportunity is timely. 2–3 sentences.][1]

A.4 Significance of the expected contribution

[State the critical need this project addresses. Describe what the field will be able to do after this project that it cannot do now. Connect to the funding priority or NIH strategic goal. 2–3 sentences.]

B. INNOVATION

This project is innovative along *[N]* distinct dimensions:

B.1 ***[Innovation 1 label.]*** *[Describe what is new about the approach, resource, or method. Contrast with prior work. 2–3 sentences.]*

B.2 ***[Innovation 2 label.]*** *[Describe the second innovative dimension. 2–3 sentences.]*

B.3 ***[Innovation 3 label.]*** *[Describe the third innovative dimension. 2–3 sentences.]*

B.4 ***[Innovation 4 label (optional).]*** *[Describe reusability, generalizability, or infrastructure innovation. 2–3 sentences.]*

C. APPROACH

C.1 Research team

[Describe the team's collective expertise and how it maps to the aims. For MPI submissions, note the Leadership Plan attachment. Name each investigator and their key qualification. Include institutional resources (computing, data governance, IRB) that support feasibility. 2–3 paragraphs.]

C.2 Preliminary studies

[Describe prior work by the team that directly supports feasibility. Connect each preliminary finding to a specific aim or methodological choice. If preliminary data are limited (as is common for pilot/R03 applications), describe conceptual or methodological groundwork. 2–3 paragraphs.]

C.3 Project design and framework

[Provide a brief overview of the overall study design and conceptual framework. State the number of phases or aims and how they build on each other. Include a figure if it aids comprehension.]

C.4 Data sources

[Describe each data source: name, scope, variables of interest, and how CP/cancer (or your target condition) is identified (e.g., ICD codes, registry criteria). State access pathway for any restricted data (dbGaP, DUA, IRB). Note which sources can be accessed immediately vs. at award initiation. Use numbered list or short paragraphs per source.]

C.5 Data analysis

C.5.1 Analytic plan for Aim 1. *[Describe the statistical or computational methods for Aim 1. Name specific models, algorithms, or tools. Describe expected inputs and outputs. State evaluation criteria used to select among competing approaches. Use underlined subheadings for major methodological steps if helpful. 3–5 sentences*

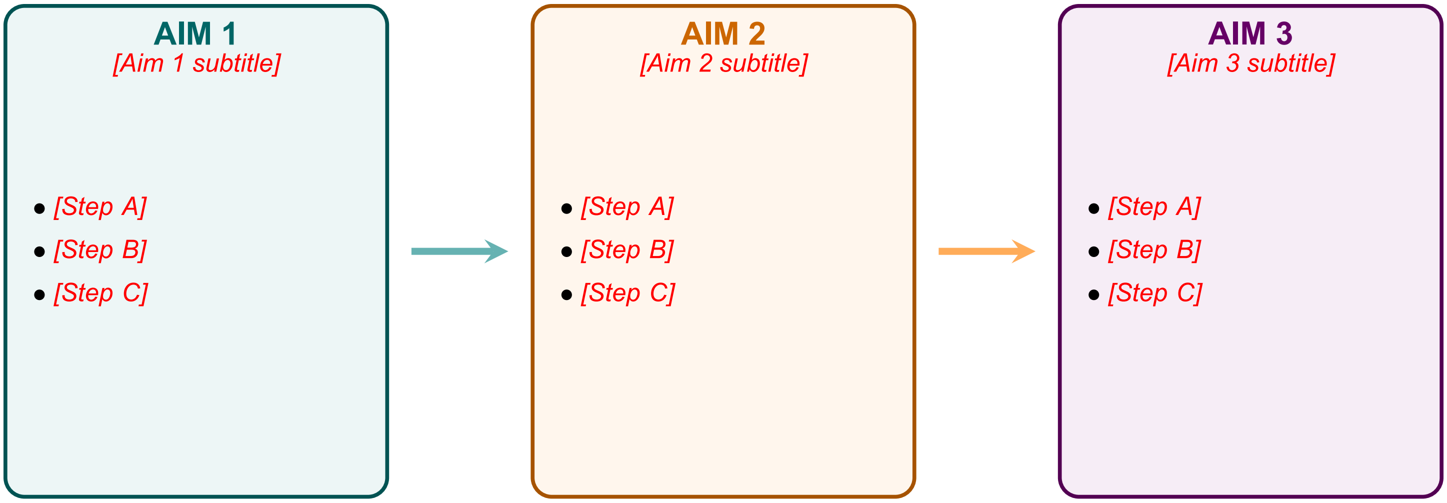

Figure 1: **Project Overview.** *[One-sentence figure caption.]*

per major step.]

C.5.2 Analytic plan for Aim 2. *[Describe the statistical or computational methods for Aim 2. Include pre-specified thresholds or benchmarks where applicable. Describe the validation or testing approach and what constitutes success. 3–5 sentences per major step.]*

C.5.3 Analytic plan for Aim 3. *[Describe the dissemination, workflow development, or deployment plan for Aim 3. Specify deliverables (code, cohorts, documentation, portal). Name the repositories, DOI mechanisms, and presentation venues. 3–5 sentences per major step.]*

C.6 Methodological Issues and Opportunities

[Describe 3–4 potential methodological problems and your mitigation strategy for each. Use a consistent structure: (1) state the risk, (2) explain why it matters, (3) describe the specific mitigation approach and fallback plan. This section demonstrates rigor — reviewers look for it. 1 paragraph per issue.]

C.7 Timeline

Conducting this study is feasible within *[N]* year(s) (Table 1). *[1–2 sentences on team readiness and why key milestones are achievable within the proposed period.]*

Table 1: **Study Timeline**